

Lerong Chen's 1 Month in Finland

Best-fit timing: 1 February - 2 March 2027 | strong snow + longer daylight + excellent aurora season

WHY FEBRUARY?
Deep, reliable snow for skiing; more daylight than mid-winter; and aurora season is still strong. The lights are natural, so no sighting is guaranteed



DAYS 1-4
Helsinki

DO
Stay centrally. Walk the harbour + Design District, ferry to Suomenlinna, then do a Finnish sauna and optional ice dip. Keep one indoor museum/cafe day for bad weather.

EAT
Fazer Cafe Kluuvikatu: Fazer biscuits, chocolate and pastries. **St. George Bakery:** sourdough + sweet buns. Also try salmon soup and korvapuusti.

SAVE
Use HSL public transport; skip taxis and expensive day tours.

DAYS 5-7
Tampere

DO
Winter walk on the Pyynikki ridge, observation tower views, lakeside sauna, and an easy cross-country-ski taster if conditions suit. Night 7: sleeper train north to Kolari.

EAT
Pyynikki Observation Tower Cafe: famous warm munkki doughnut + coffee. Add rye bread and a casual market-hall lunch.

SAVE
The sleeper cabin doubles as transport + one hotel night.

DAYS 8-14
Levi

DO
Main ski block: 3-4 downhill days for blue/red/black runs, one cross-country or snowshoe day, and one rest/spa day. Use a dark aurora viewing spot on clear nights; optional one husky/reindeer experience.

EAT
Try sauteed reindeer, mashed potato + lingonberry, leipajuusto, and a pastry/coffee stop at the fell cafes.

SAVE
Stay in a central apartment with kitchen; one premium safari only.

DAYS 15-19
Rovaniemi

DO
Bus south to the Arctic Circle. Visit Santa Claus Village once, Arktikum, Ounasvaara, and book your **one guided aurora hunt**. Add husky sledding here if not done in Levi.

EAT
Look for Lapland staples: rieska flatbread, kampanisu pastry, salmon soup, cloudberry and warm berry juice.

SAVE
Aurora tours are expensive - guide once, self-watch on other clear nights.

DAYS 20-26
Saariselka

DO
Second ski base: 2-3 downhill days, one cross-country lesson, snowshoe in Urho Kekkonen National Park, and ride the illuminated Aurora Toboggan run. Keep evenings flexible for aurora.

EAT
Warm up with soup, rye bread, berry pastries and one Lappish dinner; cook simple breakfasts in your apartment.

SAVE
Skip a glass igloo unless it fits the hard budget ceiling.

DAYS 27-30
Inari

DO
Slow finish: SIIDA Sami Museum, Lake Inari winter scenery, a reindeer/culture experience or snowshoe walk, and your final aurora nights. Day 30: bus to Ivalo airport for Helsinki/onward flight.

EAT
Restaurant Sarrit at SIIDA: lunch stop; choose Arctic fish, reindeer and local berries. Add a bakery/cafe break in Inari village.

SAVE
Keep these final days light on paid activities and protect the emergency fund.

SOLO BUDGET

Comfortable 3-star/apartment style excluding international flights

Stay + sleeper	EUR 3,300-4,100
Food	EUR 1,050-1,350
Transport	EUR 500-750
Ski + activities	EUR 900-1,300

PLAN AROUND

EUR 6,300-8,000

Keep EUR 500 untouched.

Sharing rooms can cut EUR 1,000+.

4 RULES SO MONEY DOESN'T RUIN THE TRIP

1. Book trains + Lapland apartments early; February is popular.
2. Ski mainly in Levi; use Saariselka as a shorter second ski block.
3. Pay for one aurora tour + one animal safari; self-guide the rest.
4. Apartment kitchens for breakfast/some dinners; spend on bakeries and local specialties.